TOPIC REPORTS: STRATEGIES, PLANS AND POLICIES

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

News, Sep – Oct 2026

STRATEGIES, PLANS AND POLICIES · LEGISLATION AND REGULATION · DATA PROTECTION · REGIONAL COLLABORATION · STANDARDS · PUBLIC DEBATE AND PARTICIPATION IN POLICYMAKING

Algeria · Botswana · Burkina Faso · Burundi · Cameroon · Cape Verde · Central African Republic · Chad · Comoros · Congo · Cote d'Ivoire · Djibouti · DR Congo · Egypt · Equatorial Guinea · Eritrea · Ethiopia · Gabon · Gambia · Ghana · Guinea-Bissau · Kenya · Liberia · Libya · Madagascar · Mauritania · Mauritius · Morocco · Mozambique · Nigeria · Senegal · Seychelles · Sierra Leone · South Africa · South Sudan · Sudan · Togo · Tunisia · Uganda · Zambia · Zimbabwe

Algeria

DIGITAL ALGERIA 2030 (NATIONAL DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION STRATEGY)

- **À l'ère du tout numérique** — El Moudjahid, 8 September 2026

  An El Moudjahid editorial on Algeria's Algérie Numérique 2030 strategy cites the opening of the national digital services centre at Mohammadia, with Tier III data centres, and ministries joining the Dzair Digital Services portal. It lists a product-traceability system in commerce, electronic medical records in hospitals, a national agricultural information system and the Takwin vocational training platform.

DIGITALISATION OVERSIGHT AND THE NATIONAL PORTAL

- **Portail national des services numériques : Le HCN va assurer des formations** — El Moudjahid, 19 September 2026

  Algeria's High Commission for Digitisation trained information system managers from several sectors to use a mechanism it built for verifying electronic documents issued through the Dzair Digital Services portal. Administrative bodies can then accept these documents without asking citizens to obtain them again from the issuing office. The training follows presidential instructions of 12 July 2026 to widen the portal's use.

Botswana

NATIONAL DATA STRATEGY

- **Botswana concludes capacity building and stakeholder engagement for national data strategy** — Digital Watch Observatory, 14 September 2026

  Botswana's Ministry of Communications and Innovation held a five-day data governance training and stakeholder workshop from 7 to 11 September 2026 to develop a National Data Strategy from its earlier National Data Policy. The work is backed by the African Union Commission and the European Union under the Data Governance in Africa Initiative, with AUDA-NEPAD and GIZ providing implementation support. No budget is given.

SMARTBOTS DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION STRATEGY

- **Govt targets UNEP to build smart economy** — DailyNews (Botswana Press Agency), 23 September 2026

  Botswana's President Duma Boko told UN Economic Commission for Africa head Claver Gatete in New York that the SmartBots digital transformation strategy will be formally launched in November 2026. Boko asked the commission to remain a partner in it as a flagship project. The meeting date is not stated.

Burkina Faso

NATIONAL DIGITAL TERRITORIAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN TO 2030

- **Le Burkina Faso repense l'aménagement numérique de son territoire à l'horizon 2030** — wearetech.africa, 8 September 2026

  Burkina Faso is revising its digital territorial development plan to a 2030 horizon, against an international union figure putting about 70 per cent of the population off the internet in 2024.

Burundi

DRAFT LAW ON ACCESS TO PUBLIC INFORMATION

- **Burundi adopts Right-to-Information Law, with broad exceptions** — Burundi Times, 30 September 2026

  Burundi's Senate unanimously adopted a bill on 29 September 2026 creating a legal right of access to public information. It sets up a National Commission on Access to Public Information to hear appeals and requires covered bodies to publish some information proactively, with exceptions for national security, private life and ongoing judicial investigations. The bill sets no ceiling on access fees.

Cameroon

MASTER PLAN FOR DIGITISING THE PUBLIC-PROCUREMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **Le Cameroun prépare un plan directeur pour numériser ses marchés publics** — Camerounlink, 2 September 2026

  Cameroon is commissioning a national master plan to digitise its public-procurement information system; the African Development Bank published the contract award on 31 August 2026. The six-month study went to the NC Consulting and Eyra International grouping for FCFA 241.36 million, funded under the AfDB-backed public-finance governance project PAGFIP.

- **Cameroun : Un plan directeur pour achever la digitalisation des marchés publics** — Le quotidien L'Economie, 8 September 2026

  The African Development Bank awarded the NC Consulting/Eyra International grouping a six-month, FCFA 241.36 million contract to draw up Cameroon's master plan for digitalising public procurement. The plan is to cover the whole procurement cycle and the gaps that limit use of COLEPS, the e-procurement platform run since 2018. No award date is given.

Cape Verde

PRIORITIES FOR THE UNITED NATIONS PARTNERSHIP CYCLE

- **Governo prioriza modernização do Estado, ação climática e juventude na parceria com a ONU** — Expresso das Ilhas, 10 September 2026

  Cabo Verde's prime minister named state modernisation and digital transformation, alongside climate action, decentralisation and youth opportunity, as the government's priorities for the new phase of its United Nations partnership, at a high-level meeting with the country team in Praia.

MAIO TRANSFORMA ISLAND TRANSFORMATION PROGRAMME

- **Maio: Governo apresenta programa "Maio Transforma" para acelerar economia e transformação digital da ilha** — Inforpress, 16 September 2026

  Cabo Verde's economy and digital transition ministry presented 'Maio Transforma' on the island of Maio on 16 September 2026, a programme within the national 'Cabo Verde Transforma' pilot to develop farming, fishing, enterprise and the digital economy. Minister António Baptista said projects on internet access and training would start within days. No budget is given.

Central African Republic

AGENCE CENTRAFRICAINE DE DÉVELOPPEMENT DU DIGITAL (ACDD)

- **L'Agence — ACDD : un opérateur public au service de la transformation numérique** — Agence Centrafricaine de Développement du Digital (ACDD), 11 October 2026

  The Central African Republic's digital development agency sets out its own footing: a public industrial and commercial establishment created by a law of June 2023, with a mandate to implement the national digital strategy. The page gives no budget, staffing or activity figures.

Chad

TCHAD CONNEXION 2030

- **790 millions de dollars déjà engagés dans Tchad Connexion 2030** — Les Faits d'ici, 8 September 2026

  Seventeen companies presented investment agreements with Chad worth about US$790.5 million in N'Djamena on 4 September 2026, under the Tchad Connexion 2030 plan. That is about 3.9% of the US$20.5 billion pledged at the Abu Dhabi forum in November 2025; the deals cover agro-industry, livestock, construction and telecoms and are expected to create 7,500 direct jobs.

NATIONAL DATA GOVERNANCE STRATEGY

- **Chad validates National Data Governance Strategy, marking a key milestone in its digital transformation** — United Nations Economic Commission for Africa, 7 October 2026

  Chad validated its National Data Governance Strategy at a workshop in N'Djamena on 7 October 2026, convened by the UN Economic Commission for Africa with the telecommunications and digital economy ministry. The strategy has seven pillars, including the legal framework, interoperability, and security and personal data protection. ECA and GIZ urged a move to implementation; no cost or timetable is given.

- **TRANSFORMATION NUMÉRIQUE : LE TCHAD BÂTIT SA SOUVERAINETÉ DE LA DONNÉE** — CamerPressAgency, 7 October 2026

  Chad's telecoms and digital economy minister Haliki Choua Mahamat opened a workshop in N'Djamena to validate the National Data Governance Strategy, reported on 7 October 2026. The strategy runs to 2030 and has seven pillars, including institutional governance, interoperability, personal data protection and skills, with health, education, agriculture, mining and digital finance named as priority sectors. No budget is given.

Comoros

DIGITAL READINESS ASSESSMENT WITH UNDP

- **Transformation numérique : les Comores passent à l'évaluation** — wearetech.africa, 18 September 2026

The Comoros' digital development agency and UNDP signed a memorandum on 16 September to run a national digital readiness assessment covering skills, connectivity, public services, regulation and the digital economy across the three islands. It is presented as a way to target the next investments under the Comores Numérique 2028 strategy; no timetable is given.

Congo

ARPCE LIVRE BLANC ON THE DIGITAL ECONOMY, SECOND EDITION

- **Livre Blanc et adressage postal : l'ARPCE pose les fondations de l'État numérique** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 17 October 2026

  Congo's regulator ARPCE presented the second edition of its Livre Blanc and a digital postal-addressing project in Brazzaville on 15 October 2026. The minister asked that addressing be built as public infrastructure that works with digital ID, the data-exchange platform and payments, and the Livre Blanc's conclusions go to the interministerial task force on digitalising the administration.

Cote d'Ivoire

TARGET OF 700 DIGITAL PUBLIC SERVICES BY 2029

- **Administration numérique : la Côte d'Ivoire vise 700 services publics digitalisés d'ici 2029** — RTI Infos, 3 September 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire's digital transition minister, Djibril Ouattara, said on 3 September 2026 that the government aims for 700 coordinated digital public services by 2029. A two-day workshop in Abidjan with the state IT company SNDI was to select a first portfolio of about 100 priority services, built on a single digital identity, an interoperability platform and a World Bank-supported inventory of existing infrastructure.

- **Transformation numérique : La Côte d'Ivoire priorise les services publics à fort impact** — FratMat, 3 September 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire's digital transition ministry and the state IT company SNDI held a national workshop on 3 and 4 September 2026 in Abidjan to choose which public services to digitise first. Expected outputs include a first catalogue of about 100 services built on the national interoperability platform, which SNDI's director general said is already exchanging data between administrations.

- **En quête d'efficacité, la Côte d'Ivoire vise 700 services publics en ligne d'ici 2029** — wearetech.africa, 4 September 2026

  Cote d'Ivoire set a target of 700 high-impact digital public services by 2029 and a zero-paper administration by 2030, at a national prioritisation workshop in Abidjan. A first portfolio of about 100 services is to be built or rebuilt on the national interoperability platform so one administration can draw on data another already holds; the ministry acknowledged that data exchange between existing platforms remains limited and that some functions were built twice.

NATIONAL DIGITAL COUNCIL (CN DIGIT)

- **Digitalisation des services publics : la Côte d'Ivoire veut un pilote unique pour ses projets d'État** — Linfodrome, 4 September 2026

  A national workshop in Abidjan on digital public services closed on 4 September 2026 having selected 59 priority services from 620 mapped, with ten quick wins to be deployed by the end of 2026. Côte d'Ivoire's digital transition minister, Djibril Ouattara, proposed reviving the national digital council, CN Digit, under the prime minister, with three decrees planned.

DIGITAL AND ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE COMPACT

- **Avis de résultats de la manifestation d'intérêt N° CI-PADCI-564344-CS-CQS-26** — Jeune Afrique (annonce), 30 September 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire's Digital Acceleration Project (PADCI) shortlisted six firms or consortia to support implementation of the country's digital and AI compact, in a notice published on 30 September 2026. They include KPMG CI, Deloitte, Qualisys Consulting and a group led by FTHM International with IDATE; seven bidders, among them Dalberg and the Tony Blair Institute, were not retained. Selection is on quality and cost.

Djibouti

CADRE D'INTEROPERABILITE DE DJIBOUTI

- **Djibouti – 2026 Government work programme: Omar Guelleh sets out his key priorities** — Africa24 TV, 6 September 2026

  Djibouti's President Ismaïl Omar Guelleh set the government's 2026 priorities at the Council of Ministers on 1 September 2026, including action on cybersecurity and disinformation. He named digitalised procedures, paperless public services and interoperability between administrations as means of modernising the state, listed the digital economy for diversification and announced a national forum on artificial intelligence.

DR Congo

TELECOM INFRASTRUCTURE-SHARING AND TAXATION STUDIES UNDER THE CONNECTIVITY PROJECT

- **PACT et telecoms en RDC : baisse des couts en vue** — Numerico.cd, 9 September 2026

  A workshop in Kinshasa on 9 September 2026, under the World Bank-supported connectivity and transport project PACT, presented two studies on the Democratic Republic of Congo's telecoms sector: one on infrastructure sharing, roaming and the .cd domain, the other on taxation. Recommendations include requiring operators to give the regulator current infrastructure data and a central infrastructure database updated twice a year.

Egypt

NATIONAL DATA-CENTRE STRATEGY

- **Egypt Partners With Vodafone, Elsewedy and Cassava on $1bn Data Centre Investment** — Tech Africa News, 8 September 2026

  Two data centre partnerships announced in Cairo project about US$1 billion of investment between them. The first establishes Africa Data Centres Egypt, combining Vodafone Business, Elsewedy Electric and Cassava Technologies, starting at 20MW over three years on a targeted path to 200MW; the second, between Vodafone Business and Cassava, is described as Egypt's first sovereign AI data centre, offering GPU-as-a-Service locally so that AI workloads run without moving data out of the country. The sums are projections stated at announcement rather than committed capital.

- **رئيس الوزراء يتابع مستجدات العمل لعدد من مشروعات تكنولوجيا المعلومات** — Youm7, 20 September 2026

  Egypt's communications minister told a cabinet meeting on digital projects that the ministry is drawing up an integrated national data-centre strategy with other ministries, to expand capacity inside the country. He set out the incumbent's programme to replace copper with fibre nationally, including in the villages of the rural development initiative, and the finance minister said state spending is being steered towards digital infrastructure and artificial intelligence. No text, timetable or cost was given.

- **ICT Minister unveils data centre strategy plans at FDC Summit** — Egyptian Gazette, 22 September 2026

  Egypt's communications minister Raafat Hendy said a national data centre strategy will be launched by the end of 2026, opening the FDC Summit in Cairo. He also set a target of 400 services on the Digital Egypt platform by 2030, through wider digital identity, e-signature and digital mail.

DIGITAL EGYPT SERVICE-COVERAGE TARGETS

- **وزارة الاتصالات تستهدف إتاحة 400 خدمة على منصة مصر الرقمية بحلول 2030** — جريدة حابي (Hapi Journal), 9 September 2026

  Egypt's communications minister Raafat Hendy put the Digital Egypt platform at about 245 live services and set a target of more than 400 by 2030, and said a digital identity platform has launched so that transactions requiring personal verification — powers of attorney, notarisation — can be completed without attending an office. He also said an integrated data centre strategy is being prepared for launch by the end of 2026, and that outsourcing exports reached $5.1bn in 2025 against an $8bn target for 2028; ITIDA put outsourcing employment above 195,000, from about 90,000 in 2021. The report is of the minister's remarks to a business delegation, and none of the targets carries a published implementation document.

- **وزير الاتصالات يبحث مع لجنة صناعة الاتصالات تعزيز التصنيع المحلي وتطوير مراكز البيانات** — Ahram Gate (Al-Ahram), 3 October 2026

  Egypt's communications minister, Raafat Hendy, met the regulator NTRA's reconstituted Telecom Industry Committee, which recommended expanding local manufacture of telecoms equipment and studying data-centre and cloud development. Hendy said Digital Egypt offers about 250 services, with 270 targeted by end-2026. NTRA said the biometric digital identity system is in trial with the four mobile operators.

Equatorial Guinea

NATIONAL DIGITAL STRATEGY

- **El Ministerio de Telecomunicaciones acelera la transformación digital con el respaldo del Grupo Banco Mundial** — Oficina de Información y Prensa de Guinea Ecuatorial, 2 September 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's Ministry of Transport, Telecommunications and Civil Aviation opened a four-day working session in Malabo on 2 September 2026 with eight World Bank Group specialists. Its aims are to finish and validate the national digital economy strategy, complete the sector's legal framework and prepare a World Bank-financed project, which would be the Bank's first operation in the country in 35 years.

Eritrea

NATIONAL POLICY FOR ICT IN EDUCATION AND THE EDUCATION SECTOR PLAN

- **Eritrea — Technology (Education Profile)** — UNESCO GEM Report — Profiles Enhancing Education Reviews (PEER), 2 September 2026

  UNESCO's education profile for Eritrea describes technology in education under the 2018–2022 National Education Sector Plan, which uses terms such as ICT, e-learning and distance learning without defining them. The 1997 Constitution mentions technology only in connection with science, arts and sports. The profile is on a legacy site that is no longer updated.

Ethiopia

NATIONAL FINANCIAL INCLUSION STRATEGY III (2026-2030)

- **High Digital Transaction Costs, Fraud Gaps Threaten Ethiopia's Financial Inclusion Targets: Report** — The Reporter, 3 October 2026

> An assessment of Ethiopia's second financial inclusion strategy found adult account ownership at 66 per cent in 2025 against a 70 per cent target, with some banks charging up to 11 per cent for transfers to mobile wallets. Only 29.56 per cent of 157.6 million mobile money accounts were active in June 2026; a third strategy, for 2026 to 2030, was launched alongside it.

Gabon

> GOVERNANCE OF MINISTERIAL INFORMATION SYSTEMS

- **Communiqué final du Conseil des ministres du 18 septembre 2026** — Présidence de la République gabonaise (via AGP), 18 September 2026

  Gabon's Council of Ministers, meeting in Port-Gentil on 18 September 2026, adopted a decree on issuing qualified electronic-signature certificates and other trust services, including e-seals, e-invoices and the e-visa, and three decrees reorganising the national statistics institute, council and fund. It also approved hosting an African preparatory meeting for the ITU Plenipotentiary Conference in Libreville.

- **Gabon: DGDINC and ANINF, two structures for the same digital missions?** — Gabon Media Time, 21 September 2026

  Gabon's Council of Ministers appointed Anicet Claude Andjouat on 18 September 2026 to head a new Directorate-General for digital infrastructure and cybersecurity, created in December 2025. Gabon Media Time reports that the directorate's remit over spectrum, digital infrastructure and cybersecurity overlaps with that of the existing agency ANINF, and that no public division of responsibilities has been set out.

> NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE STRATEGY

- **Intelligence artificielle : le Gabon veut définir ses besoins avant de fixer son cap** — GabonReview, 27 September 2026

  Gabon's digital economy ministry and the UN Development Programme opened consultations toward a national artificial intelligence strategy, held in Libreville from 28 to 30 September 2026. The announcement sets out the themes but gives no budget, adoption date or priority uses.

- **22 défis, 36 recommandations : la feuille de route de l'IA gabonaise prend forme** — GabonReview, 1 October 2026

  Preparatory work for Gabon's national AI strategy closed in Libreville on 30 September with 22 challenges and 36 recommendations from six working groups supported by UNDP. The ministry and UNDP will now draft the strategy, its action plan and financing for government validation.

Gambia

> SCIENCE, TECHNOLOGY AND INNOVATION POLICY 2027-2035

- **MOHERST moves to strengthen science, technology and innovation** — The Standard Newspaper (Gambia), 3 September 2026

  The Gambia's Ministry of Higher Education, Research, Science and Technology held a validation workshop on the draft National Science, Technology and Innovation Policy 2027–2035 and the STI Bill 2026. Minister Pierre Gomez said none of the previous policy's 12 core objectives was fully met; the new one proposes an STI secretariat and a National Research and Innovation Fund.

Ghana

NATIONAL AI IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

- **Gov't rolls out measures to address Ghana's AI, digital infrastructure gaps - Sam George** — Citi Newsroom, 15 September 2026

  The communications minister said government has begun implementing measures against gaps a UNESCO readiness assessment identified in digital infrastructure, artificial intelligence capacity and cybersecurity, putting US$250m against an AI computing centre and US$200m against digitalisation.

CENTRALISED TECHNICAL REVIEW OF PUBLIC-SECTOR AI PROCUREMENT

- **Ghana tightens scrutiny of public sector AI buys** — ITWeb Africa, 2 October 2026

  Ghana's communications minister announced that every AI system bought by a public institution will go through a centralised technical review. The national information technology agency will scope deployments against interoperability, data-protection, cybersecurity and local skills-transfer requirements, alongside procurement law.

DIGITAL HEALTH POLICY AND STRATEGY 2023-2027

- **WHO and UNDP support Ghana to integrate artificial intelligence into digital health strategy** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 12 October 2026

  Ghana's Ministry of Health and Ghana Health Service, supported by WHO and UNDP, are reviewing the Digital Health Policy and Strategy 2023–2027 to incorporate AI, reported on 12 October 2026. The programme focuses on AI-enabled disease surveillance combining routine health data with climate data for malaria, cholera and meningitis. No start date or cost is given.

Guinea-Bissau

PROJECT DOCUMENT FOR IMPLEMENTING THE NATIONAL DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION STRATEGY

- **UNU-EGOV Welcomes Delegation from Guinea-Bissau** — United Nations University – Operating Unit on Policy-Driven Electronic Governance (UNU-EGOV), 23 September 2026

  A delegation from Guinea-Bissau's Ministry of Territorial Administration and Local Government, including two regional secretaries, visited the UN University's e-governance unit in Guimarães, Portugal, on 9 September 2026. They discussed the unit's project document for implementing Guinea-Bissau's national digital transformation strategy. No agreement was announced.

Kenya

INVESTOR CONFIDENCE IN THE DIGITAL INVESTMENT CLIMATE

- **US tech giants flag Kenya investment risks** — Daily Nation, 10 September 2026

  Executives from four large United States technology and payments companies told a Nairobi business summit that unpredictable taxes, regulations and approvals could deter new capital from Kenya. They said investors need policy certainty to commit and expand, a warning aimed at the country's bid to be East Africa's digital investment hub.

NATIONAL COMMUNICATION POLICY: ENHANCING TRUST IN GOVERNMENT

- **One Government, One Voice: Isaboke on Kenya's new communication revolution** — The Star, 14 September 2026

Kenya's broadcasting and telecoms principal secretary, Stephen Isaboke, said a new National Communication Policy creates a National Communication Centre to validate and release state information, and ties ministries' communication plans to performance contracts. He called his department's KES 6.4 billion 2026 allocation inadequate and said digitised government services rose from 353 in 2022 to more than 21,500.

- **Gov't to tackle misinformation through coordinated communication as PS Isaboke unveils new measures to rebuild public trust - TV47 Digital** — TV47 Digital, 16 September 2026

  Kenya's broadcasting principal secretary Stephen Isaboke directed all ministries, departments and agencies to build communication into their programmes under the National Communication Policy 2026, at a forum opened on 15 September 2026. The National Communication Centre is being strengthened as the government's information repository, using AI tools for public sentiment analysis.

NATIONAL PAYMENT SYSTEM POLICY (DRAFT, AUGUST 2026)

- **Draft National Payment System Policy and National Payment System Bill, 2026** — Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's National Treasury and central bank published a draft National Payment System Policy and a draft National Payment System Bill, 2026 for public comment on 21 September 2026. The bill would replace the current Act and license payment providers and system operators by category, with minimum capital of Ksh5 million to Ksh250 million. It also requires interoperability, allows open-finance data sharing with consent and brings virtual asset providers that offer payments under the law, while the policy commits the government to a national instant payment switch.

- **Draft National Payment System Policy, August 2026** — The National Treasury, Republic of Kenya, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's draft National Payment System Policy, dated August 2026, which identifies ten gaps in the current system. It commits to a national instant payment switch, requires open APIs and gives non-banks access to settlement. The consultation is summarised under the Treasury and central bank's joint release.

ACCESS TO INFORMATION POLICY

- **State vows proactive disclosure as Kenya marks access to information day** — The Star (Kenya), 27 September 2026

  Kenya's Broadcasting and Telecommunications Principal Secretary, Steve Isaboke, said on 24 September 2026 that the government will publish information before citizens have to request it, and that with a newly approved Access to Information Policy the focus now shifts to implementing the 2016 Act. He spoke at a forum hosted by the Finnish embassy with UNESCO and the Commission on Administrative Justice.

- **CS Kabogo gazettes new policy to boost public access to government information** — People Daily, 13 October 2026

  Kenya's ICT Cabinet Secretary gazetted the Access to Information Policy, 2026 on 9 October. It requires public offices to disclose key records proactively, answer requests within set timelines and give written reasons for refusals.

- **Kenya Has a New Law-Backed Plan to Force Public Offices to Release Records. Will It Work?** — Dawan Africa, 13 October 2026

  An explainer on Kenya's newly gazetted Access to Information Policy asks whether it will change practice: citizens already hold a right to request records, it notes, but often do not get them.

NATIONAL AI POLICY FOR SCIENCE, RESEARCH AND INNOVATION

- **Invitation for Public Participation in the Review of the Draft National AI Policy for Science, Research and Innovation and the Draft Science Diplomacy Policy** — State Department for Science, Research and Innovation (Kenya), 1 October 2026

  Kenya's State Department for Science, Research and Innovation invited public comment on a draft National AI Policy for Science, Research and Innovation and a draft Science Diplomacy Policy, with a deadline of 14 October 2026. The drafts are posted on the department's website. The notice is undated.

Liberia

NATIONAL FINANCIAL INCLUSION AND EDUCATION STRATEGY 2026-2030

- **Liberia: CBL's New Financial Inclusion Plan Hinges on ID, Business Registry Reforms** — FrontPage Africa, 16 September 2026

  Liberia's draft national financial inclusion and education strategy went through a two-day validation and will be revised. Participants said its success depends on the identity registry, business registration and credit reference systems, and parts will need legislation and budget.

Libya

NATIONAL POLICY FOR OPEN DATA AND ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **الهيئة العامة للمعلومات تبحث مع ممثلي مراكز المعلومات والتوثيق القطاعية مسودة السياسة الوطنية للبيانات المفتوحة والذكاء الاصطناعي - gia** — General Information Authority (Libya), 15 October 2026

  Libya's General Information Authority met sectoral information centres, ministries and outside experts on 14 October 2026 to work the results of its national survey of government bodies into the final draft of a National Policy for Open Data and Artificial Intelligence. An ESCWA expert presented regional and international practice; the draft itself is not public.

Madagascar

OPEN GOVERNMENT PARTNERSHIP READHESION

- **Gouvernement ouvert : Madagascar à trois points du seuil requis** — Midi Madagasikara, 9 October 2026

  Madagascar scores 9 of 16 points against the 12 it needs to rejoin the Open Government Partnership, which it first joined in 2016. A colloquium is drafting commitments for a national action plan for 2026 to 2030.

Mauritania

NATIONAL DIGITAL PAYMENT STRATEGY 2023-2028

- **Stratégie Nationale de Paiement Numérique (SNPN)** — Banque Centrale de Mauritanie, 6 September 2026

  Mauritania's central bank publishes its National Digital Payment Strategy on its fintech portal, presented as a natural extension of the national financial inclusion strategy and aimed at widening access to financial services for rural and under-banked citizens. It sets five objectives: easing the regulation of payment and electronic-money institutions to attract fintech investment, rebuilding the digital payments infrastructure, modernising financial services around innovation, building adoption and use, and putting a governance system in place across the whole financial-digital sector. No implementation report or measured outturn against any of them appears on the page.

NATIONAL FRAMEWORK RESTRICTING MINORS' ACCESS TO SOCIAL MEDIA

- مجلس الوزراء يصادق على بيانين حول الحماية من مضار الفضاء الرقمي وتنظيم منتدى الجاليات الموريتانية في الخارج — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 16 September 2026

  Mauritania's Council of Ministers took a statement on 16 September 2026 proposing a national framework on minors' use of social media, with an access threshold at 16. It would switch off recommendation algorithms, infinite scroll and autoplay for minors by default, ban advertising aimed at them and add a reporting route for children harmed online; no draft text has been published.

- وزير تمكين الشباب: نعمل على اتخاذ إجراءات جديدة لحماية القاصرين من مخاطر منصات التواصل الاجتماعي — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 16 September 2026

  Mauritania's youth minister said the government is preparing legal and technical measures to protect minors on social media. The Council of Ministers approved an interministerial committee, including the population registry agency and the data protection authority, to propose a framework law with technical mechanisms to limit children's access to harmful platforms. A draft law banning online gambling is also being prepared.

Mauritius

MAURITIUS VISION 2050

- **Conseil des ministres | «Mauritius Vision 2050» : l'objectif d'une économie à USD 50 milliards d'ici 2050** — L'Express (Maurice), 11 September 2026

  Mauritius's Cabinet approved the final report of Mauritius Vision 2050 on 11 September 2026, aiming for an economy of about USD 50 billion (about Rs 2,300 billion) by 2050. It rests on prosperity, sustainability and inclusivity, and names digital among seven strategic sectors alongside financial services, tourism, logistics, the ocean economy, high-value agriculture and life sciences.

Morocco

MINISTRY OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION AND ADMINISTRATION REFORM

- **Morocco appoints Ahmed Rahhou as Minister of Artificial Intelligence, Digital Transformation and Administration Reform** — Tech Review Africa, 16 October 2026

  King Mohammed VI swore in Ahmed Rahhou on 16 October 2026 as Minister of Artificial Intelligence, Digital Transformation and Administration Reform in Fatima Ezzahra El Mansouri's new government. He replaces Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni, and the new ministry brings AI, digital transformation and administrative reform under one portfolio.

- **SM le Roi préside la cérémonie de nomination des membres du nouveau gouvernement** — Maroc.ma (Government of Morocco portal), 16 October 2026

  King Mohammed VI presided over the swearing-in of Morocco's new government at the Royal Palace in Rabat on 16 October 2026, according to the government portal. Ahmed Rahhou heads the ministry covering artificial intelligence and digital affairs, with Aicha Guellaa as delegated minister for administration reform.

Mozambique

DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION OPERATIONAL PLAN 2026-2029

- **Transformação Digital em Moçambique: ATDI e instituições alinham prioridades para modernizar o Estado** — MZNews, 15 September 2026

The digital transformation agency met in Maputo to set the basis of an operational plan for 2026 to 2029, its stated aim to replace isolated systems with a common architecture. A sovereign cloud and data centre and a national interoperability platform are among the priorities.

- **Governo Garante "Soberania do Estado" Sobre Dados Públicos** — Diário Económico, 21 September 2026

  A second account of the Mozambique digital transformation meeting, summarised under the AIM report. It leads on the state administration minister, Inocêncio Impissa, saying that data produced by public bodies must belong to the state. The plan has not yet been costed.

- **Governo quer acelerar transformação digital dos serviços públicos até 2029** — Agência de Informação de Moçambique (AIM), 21 September 2026

  Mozambique is drafting a three-year operational plan to speed up the digitisation of public services to 2029. At a meeting of the technical commission on digital transformation in Maputo on 21 September 2026, the head of the digital transformation agency said the Citizen Portal already offered about 26 services and had over 3,000 users before its official launch. An interoperability portal, a payments platform for state services, a government cloud and a government data centre are to follow. The commission expects to harmonise and cost the plan within two to three months, with funding spread across many donor projects.

STRATEGIC PLAN FOR THE INFORMATION SOCIETY 2019-2028 (RESOLUTION 52/2019)

- **Digital Inclusion in Africa: Mapping the Ecosystem Gap** — Paradigm Initiative, 22 September 2026

  ETHIOPIA · ALGERIA · NAMIBIA · CÔTE D'IVOIRE · DRC · AFRICA

  Paradigm Initiative published a baseline study on 22 September 2026 of digital inclusion in Ethiopia, Algeria, Namibia, Côte d'Ivoire, Mozambique and DR Congo. It compares the six countries' policy commitments, funding, governance and private-sector involvement, and notes that access remains uneven for young people, women and rural populations.

POSTAL SECTOR TRANSFORMATION STRATEGY AND IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

- **Mozambique's INCM Seeks Consultants to Modernise Postal Sector** — Tech Africa News, 23 September 2026

  Mozambique's regulator INCM has called for expressions of interest (ref. INCM/SC/95/2026) for a six-month study of the postal market and a transformation strategy and roadmap, with particular attention to the designated operator CORREIOS. The scope includes digital transformation, postal financial services and e-commerce.

INTERNET FOR ALL STRATEGY

- **Only 15% of Mozambicans can afford mobile internet access** — Club of Mozambique, 7 October 2026

  A proposed Internet for All strategy for Mozambique, to be implemented by the communications regulator with targets to 2030, was presented in Maputo. A partner organisation said only 15% of the population can afford to keep a mobile data package, against about 5.6 million mobile internet subscribers in some 36 million people.

PUBLIC FINANCE MANAGEMENT STRATEGY (EGFP) 2026-2035

- **Mozambique Plans to Integrate AI into Public Finance Management Systems** — Consulting.co.mz, 12 October 2026

> Mozambique's government approved a Public Finance Management Strategy for 2026–2035 that includes a digital transformation plan for 2026–2030. It names AI, machine learning, data mining and the Internet of Things for treasury, debt and state-asset management, and puts all major processes on the e-SISTAFE system by 2035. The approval date is not stated.

Nigeria

> NATIONAL DIGITAL CLOUD POLICY

- **Nigeria harnesses $1bn public IT demand to power data cloud ecosystem** — ConsumerConnect, 9 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  The director-general of Nigeria's National Information Technology Development Agency, Kashifu Inuwa Abdullahi, told ITW Data Cloud Africa 2026 in Nairobi that federal bodies generate nearly US$1 billion a year in IT demand, which a Cloud-First Policy will direct to cloud and shared infrastructure. He said 326 ministries and agencies spent N3.89 trillion on technology between 2023 and mid-2026, and local data capacity runs at nearly 90% utilisation.

- **Nigeria Links Data Sovereignty, AI to Fresh Digital Infrastructure Investment** — Leadership, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  Nigeria is seeking to convert its digital policies and data-sovereignty requirements into investable opportunities for private capital through a national cloud infrastructure strategy, the technology development agency's director-general said. He was speaking at a Nairobi conference session on turning policy into investable demand.

- **Nigeria Shifts From Regulation to Market Enablement to Attract Digital Infrastructure Investment** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's technology development agency is shifting from a traditional regulatory posture to actively enabling market growth and private investment in digital infrastructure, its director-general said in a fireside chat at a Nairobi conference. The session formed part of a workshop on the country's digital infrastructure opportunity.

- **NITDA Unveils Cloud Policy Package to Drive Nigeria's Digital Infrastructure Growth - TechAfrica News** — TechAfrica News, 14 September 2026

  Nigeria's IT development agency NITDA released four cloud policy instruments, reported on 14 September 2026, under a Cloud First mandate for government: a cloud computing guideline, a technical guideline, a single national certification for data centres and cloud services, and an investment strategy with the government as anchor customer. It puts Nigeria's cloud market at US$1.03bn in 2025, rising to a projected US$3.28bn in 2030.

> NATIONAL FINANCIAL INCLUSION STRATEGY 4.0

- **CBN begins work on new financial inclusion strategy, targets deeper access** — Premium Times, 16 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Nigeria said on 16 September 2026 it has completed its review of the third National Financial Inclusion Strategy and begun a fourth, focused on usage, affordability and safety. It put Bank Verification Number enrolment at 67.8 million at end-2025 and its shared agent network above 2 million, and plans a geospatial register of financial access points.

> DIGITAL FREE ZONES INITIATIVE

- **Tinubu: We Have Moved Digital Free Zones Initiative To Implementation Stage** — ThisDay, 18 September 2026

  The president declared Nigeria's Digital Free Zones initiative moved to its implementation stage, with one zone licensed. The stated aim is that Nigerian technology and service companies raise global capital and serve international markets without incorporating or holding intellectual property abroad; the declaration came through an adviser's release and carries no zone count, investment figure or timetable.

NATIONAL STRATEGY ON PUBLIC SERVICE REFORMS

- **President Tinubu Approves National Strategy on Public Service Reforms** — ThisDay, 1 October 2026

  President Bola Tinubu has approved a renewed National Strategy on Public Service Reforms, the director general of Nigeria's Bureau of Public Service Reforms, Dasuki Arabi, said in Abuja on 30 September 2026. The three-yearly revision will add government policies on AI and blockchain in the public service. No approval date or text was given.

NCC INTERNET GOVERNANCE WORKING GROUP

- **NCC Launches Internet Governance Working Group to Strengthen Online Safety and AI Accountability** — Nigerian Communications Commission, 18 October 2026

  The Nigerian Communications Commission launched an Internet Governance Working Group at its first Internet Governance Symposium, held in Lagos on 15 October 2026. The commission called for wider cooperation on artificial intelligence, online fraud, privacy and child protection, and cited its Internet Code of Practice 2026 and a cyber resilience framework for the sector.

Senegal

NATIONAL INTEROPERABILITY PLATFORM

- **Accueil - Plateforme Interopérabilité | Jokkoo** — Plateforme d'Interopérabilité du Sénégal (PINS / e-Jokkoo), 3 September 2026

  Senegal's national interoperability platform, branded e-Jokkoo, describes itself as the backbone connecting state information systems for secure data exchange between administrations. It is built on X-Road and offers an API gateway, digital identity and data exchange services. Its counters for connected administrations, active APIs and monthly transactions show no figures.

- **Termes de références pour les services de Consultant (cabinet) pour l'étude des besoins en infrastructure technique de la Plateforme d'Interopérabilité Nationale du Sénégal (PINS) basée sur X-Road (SN-MCTN-567507-CS-QCBS)** — Projet d'Accélération de l'Économie Numérique au Sénégal (PAENS) / Ministère des Télécommunications et du Numérique, 22 September 2026

  Senegal's digital economy acceleration project, PAENS, financed by the World Bank, posted terms of reference on 22 September 2026 for a consultancy firm to study the technical infrastructure needed by the X-Road-based national interoperability platform, PINS. The four-month study covers hosting at the state digital infrastructure company SENUM or sectoral sites and integration with the national PKI. PAENS totals EUR 144.9 million over 2023-2028.

- **Appel à manifestation d'intérêt : Étude des besoins en infrastructure de la Plateforme d'Interopérabilité Nationale (PINS)** — GuindiMa, 24 September 2026

Senegal's Ministry of Telecommunications and Digital Economy invited firms on 24 September 2026 to bid for a study of infrastructure needs for the national interoperability platform PINS, based on X-Road, under the World Bank-financed PAENS project. The consultant is to design an architecture that starts small and grows across national and sectoral data centres, integrated with the national PKI. Bids closed on 7 October.

UNIVERSAL DIGITAL ACCESS PROGRAMME

- **PANU — Le Programme d'Accès Numérique Universel** — Fonds de Développement du Service Universel des Télécommunications (FDSUT), 3 September 2026

  Senegal's universal telecoms service fund (FDSUT) runs the Universal Digital Access Programme (PANU), which aims by 2028 to cover 1,550 localities with at least 4G, equip 200 public bodies with digital tools, develop five digital services or applications and train 500 people in digital trades. The page's progress counters show zero against each target.

NEW DEAL TECHNOLOGIQUE 2034

- **New Technological Deal, or how a Global South Digital strategy for impactful ICT Transformation** — Digital Watch Observatory (DiploFoundation), session record of a WSIS Forum 2026 panel, 4 September 2026

  Senegalese officials presented the country's New Deal Technologique digital strategy at a WSIS Forum 2026 session, covering digital sovereignty, digital public infrastructure and skills. Speakers described free satellite kits to connect one million people over two years and a digital ID, X-Road interoperability and e-payments roadmap targeting 2030. The record gives the plan as USD 2bn over ten years, USD 700m of it unallocated.

- **Sénégal : priorités numériques recentrées sur le cloud souverain et l'IA** — wearetech.africa, 9 September 2026

  Senegal put a sovereign cloud for the state's sensitive data and an accelerated sectoral AI strategy at the centre of its digital priorities, in the prime minister's general policy statement of 8 September. The refocus sits within the New Deal technologique and narrows selection to initiatives that are feasible, financed and able to produce measurable results.

PRIME MINISTER'S GENERAL POLICY DECLARATION, SEPTEMBER 2026

- **Declaration de politique generale du Premier ministre Ahmadou Alhaminou Mohamed Lo, seance extraordinaire de l'Assemblee nationale, mardi 08 septembre 2026** — Primature, Republique du Senegal, 8 September 2026

  Senegal's prime minister, Ahmadou Alhaminou Mohamed Lo, delivered his general policy statement to the National Assembly on 8 September 2026. On digital matters it commits to securing public data and digital identities, a sovereign cloud to host the state's sensitive data on Senegalese soil, and an accelerated strategy for sectoral uses of artificial intelligence.

- **DPG : cloud souverain, IA… le gouvernement veut passer des annonces à l'exécution du New Deal technologique** — Socialnetlink, 8 September 2026

  Senegal's prime minister, Ahmadou Alhaminou Mohamed Lo, set out the government's digital priorities in his general policy statement of 8 September 2026, naming a sovereign cloud to host sensitive state data on national territory and artificial intelligence as main strands of the New Deal Technologique. Digital projects must now show feasibility, financing and impact before implementation.

BLUEPRINT FOR VALUE CREATION THROUGH DATA

- **Senegal Validates National Blueprint to Unlock Value From Data** — Tech Africa News, 23 September 2026

Senegal's digital ministry validated a draft national Blueprint on Data Valorisation at a workshop on 21 and 22 September, run with Smart Africa's Data Governance in Africa programme and GIZ. Senegal is a pilot alongside Kenya and Lesotho; the workshop refined the roadmap's implementation and monitoring framework, with no finalisation date given.

RESTRUCTURING OF THE NATIONAL POSTAL COMPANY BY 2027

- **Senegal targets postal sector restructuring by 2027 under New Deal Technologique** — Tech Review Africa, 15 October 2026

  Senegal's telecoms and digital ministry aims to restructure the postal sector by 2027 under its New Deal Technologique, refocusing the state-owned La Poste on digital and trusted services, e-commerce logistics and private partnerships. The minister set out the plan at World Post Day celebrations.

Seychelles

COMMISSION OF INQUIRY INTO THE BORDER MANAGEMENT SERVICE AGREEMENT

- **Commission of Inquiry opens into Travizory border agreement** — Seychelles Nation, 3 September 2026

  A presidential Commission of Inquiry into the border management agreement between Seychelles and Travizory Border Security SA opened at the Palais de Justice on Mahé on 2 September 2026. The immigration department uses Travizory's system for digital border control, including visitors' electronic travel authorisation. The commission's terms of reference are not given.

- **Former ministers detail early border system options before Travizory** — Seychelles Nation, 4 September 2026

  Seychelles' Commission of Inquiry into the border management agreement with Travizory Border Security heard testimony from two former ministers on how the country initially explored established international providers before Travizory entered the picture. The report is paywalled beyond that point.

DIGITAL ECONOMIC TRANSFORMATION FORUM

- **Cabinet Business, Wednesday 09th September 2026** — State House Seychelles, 9 September 2026

  Seychelles' Cabinet, chaired by President Patrick Herminie on 9 September 2026, approved a multi-stakeholder Digital Economic Transformation Forum to agree a national digital architecture, priority pilot projects and an implementation roadmap. The same meeting approved a Hydrographic Office within the Maritime Safety Authority to manage marine data.

Sierra Leone

DATA GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

- **Ministry of Communication strengthens partnership with UN on digital transformation** — Sierra Loaded, 5 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's communications minister Salima Bah met the UN Resident Coordinator, UNDP and UNFPA on data governance and digital infrastructure, reported on 5 September 2026, and showed them the Government Data Centre at NatCA Tower and plans for a backup site at State House. The ministry says it is drafting a Data Governance Framework on how government data is classified, shared and used.

OPEN SOURCE SOFTWARE POLICY

- **Sierra Leone to showcase open-source software policy at UNGA 81** — TechReviewAfrica, 15 September 2026

The communications ministry will take its open-source software agenda to a side event at the United Nations General Assembly on 24 September, with a UN partner, arguing open source supports affordable, secure and locally owned digital systems.

- **UNGA81: Sierra Leone unveils Open Source Policy to address digital fragmentation and vendor lock-in** — Tech Review Africa, 25 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's communications ministry presented a new open source policy at a UNICEF event on the sidelines of UNGA81, as its answer to duplicated government systems, rising proprietary costs, systems that cannot interoperate and vendor lock-in. The policy's text, adoption date and instrument were not given.

South Africa

REGULATOR INQUIRY INTO OVER-THE-TOP SERVICES

- **Notice of intention to conduct market inquiry into the impact of over-the-top (OTT) services on licensees and regulatory framework in South Africa - Notice 4129 of 2026** — Independent Communications Authority of South Africa (Government Gazette No. 55299), 4 September 2026

  South Africa's communications regulator, ICASA, gazetted notice of a market inquiry into the impact of over-the-top services on telecoms, broadcasting and postal licensees on 4 September 2026. The inquiry has four phases: a questionnaire with 45 working days for responses, a discussion document for comment, possible public hearings, and findings gazetted within 90 days of its conclusion.

- **OTT prices in line of fire: Icasa takes aim at Netflix and WhatsApp** — Sunday Times (TimesLIVE), 7 September 2026

  South Africa’s communications regulator said it will inquire into the effect of over-the-top services on consumers, against licensed broadcasters losing audience and revenue.

- **South Africa's industry regulator launches market inquiries into OTT services and telecom affordability** — Broadcast Media Africa, 9 September 2026

  South Africa's communications regulator ICASA launched two market inquiries, one into the effect of over-the-top services such as Netflix and WhatsApp on its telecoms, broadcasting and postal licensees, the other into telecoms affordability. Each runs in four phases, with 45 working days for written responses; findings will be published in the Government Gazette. No new charge on platforms has been announced.

NATIONAL AI POLICY

- **AI governance cannot wait for policy** — ITWeb Africa, 18 September 2026

  An opinion piece by the lead of Lefa AI argues that South African schools need AI safeguards now. It cites the 2024 TALIS survey, in which 48% of South African lower-secondary teachers had used AI against an OECD average of 36%, and a January 2026 FEDSAS survey of 99 Eastern Cape educators in which only 4% said their school had an AI policy.

- **AI policy gets a second chance** — Business Times (BusinessDay), 3 October 2026

  South Africa's deputy communications minister, Mondli Gungubele, said the redrafted national AI policy goes to the minister before the end of November 2026 and to cabinet by the end of the 2026/27 financial year. The earlier draft, released this year, was withdrawn after it was found to contain AI-generated, invented citations.

- **Malatsi wants South Africa’s AI policy back on track after false start** — TechCabal, 15 October 2026

One of the two South African officials suspended over the draft national AI policy that cited invented sources has resigned, and disciplinary proceedings continue against the other. The communications minister said cabinet will finalise a replacement before the end of March 2027, with public consultation expected from April.

DISCUSSION DOCUMENT ON SUBSIDIES FOR NEEDY PERSONS

- **Discussion Document on Categories of Needy Persons and Subsidy Application and Payment Modalities (with General Notice inviting comments)** — Universal Service and Access Agency of South Africa (USAASA), 30 September 2026

  South Africa's Universal Service and Access Agency published a discussion document on 30 September 2026 on which needy persons should receive electronic communications subsidies, who must apply and who may be paid. It sets six provisional propositions with financial inability as the central test, but proposes no income threshold, benefit amount or payment platform. Comments close on 30 October 2026.

- **Who qualifies as a 'needy person'? — Usaasa weighs new digital subsidy rules** — TimesLIVE (Sunday Times), 10 October 2026

  The Universal Service and Access Agency of South Africa has invited public comment on a discussion document on who should qualify as a 'needy person' for subsidised access to communications services, who should apply and how subsidies should be paid, reported on 10 October 2026. The consultation, under section 88 of the Electronic Communications Act, sets no income threshold. No comment deadline is given.

REGULATOR INQUIRY INTO THE IMPACT OF OVER-THE-TOP SERVICES

- **Government Gazette No. 55476 (30 September 2026): ICASA General Notice 4180 of 2026, withdrawal of Notice 4130 (affordability inquiry), and withdrawal of Notices 4129 and 4148 (OTT inquiry)** — Independent Communications Authority of South Africa (ICASA), Government Gazette No. 55476, 30 September 2026

  South Africa's communications regulator ICASA withdrew its notice of an inquiry into the affordability of telecommunications services (Notice 4130 of 2026) in Government Gazette No. 55476 of 30 September 2026. The same gazette withdrew Notices 4129 and 4148 on an inquiry into over-the-top services, and reprinted a draft notice of intention to hold the affordability inquiry in four phases.

- **ICASA withdraws notices on OTT services and telecommunications affordability inquiries** — Independent Communications Authority of South Africa (ICASA), 1 October 2026

  South Africa's communications regulator, ICASA, withdrew on 1 October 2026 its notices launching inquiries into telecommunications affordability and the impact of over-the-top services, citing administrative and procedural matters. The affordability notice will be republished with a draft questionnaire and the OTT notice later; earlier submissions can be resubmitted.

REVIEW OF THE 2010 UNIVERSAL ACCESS AND UNIVERSAL SERVICE DETERMINATION

- **Government Notice 7985 (Gazette 55494): Invitation to comment on the Discussion Document on Universal Access and Universal Service** — Universal Service and Access Agency of South Africa (USAASA), Government Gazette No. 55494, 1 October 2026

  The Universal Service and Access Agency of South Africa published a discussion document on universal access and universal service in the Government Gazette on 1 October 2026, reviewing the 2010 determination. It sets out three options and favours a targeted revision; comments close on 30 October 2026.

- **Public consultation to update universal digital access policy** — Sunday Times, 10 October 2026

South Africa's universal service agency is consulting on whether to update the 2010 determination that defines universal access and universal service. Its discussion document sets out three options and leans towards a targeted revision; it creates no new funding or licence obligations.

UNIVERSAL SERVICE AND ACCESS FUND MANUAL

- **USAASA to implement approved USAF manual** — ITWeb South Africa, 5 October 2026

  South Africa's universal service agency says the communications minister has approved the manual for the Universal Service and Access Fund, setting its objectives, governance, funding instruments and accountability. An earlier draft was withdrawn in November 2025 and a revised one went out for comment in February 2026.

South Sudan

DOMESTICATION OF THE CONTINENTAL DATA POLICY FRAMEWORK

- **South Sudan advances Data Governance Framework through capacity-building workshop** — TechReviewAfrica, 15 September 2026

  The communications authority joined a three-day workshop on domesticating the continental data policy framework, hosted by the African Union Commission, its development agency and two partners with the ICT ministry, to set a roadmap for implementation.

Sudan

CENTRAL BANK OF SUDAN FIVE-YEAR STRATEGIC PLAN 2026-2030

- **Bank of Sudan's banking sector reform strategy faces range of challenges, led by digital transformation - Dabanga Radio TV Online** — Radio Dabanga, 21 September 2026

  An analysis of the Central Bank of Sudan's 2026–2030 strategic plan, published in December 2025, which includes speeding up digital transformation in the banking system. Banker Omar Sid Ahmed argues that with about 98% of the money supply outside the banks and branches lost to the war, the plan needs a 12-month emergency programme with budgets and measurable targets. He adds that digital projects depend on infrastructure that is not yet in place.

Togo

MEDIUM-TERM REVENUE MOBILISATION STRATEGY (SRMT) 2027-2031

- **Stratégie de Mobilisation des Recettes à Moyen Terme (SRMT) 2027-2031** — Ministère des Finances et du Budget (Togo), Comité SRMT, 1 September 2026

  Togo's finance ministry published its medium-term revenue mobilisation strategy for 2027-2031 in September 2026. Of its FCFA 10.5 billion cost, FCFA 5,995 million goes to digital transformation, including e-invoicing, links between the revenue authority and treasury systems, AI-assisted risk analysis for tax and customs, and sovereign data hosting. The measures target FCFA 481 billion in extra revenue, with 80% of the cost expected from partners.

- **Fisc : l'IA pour traquer les fraudeurs** — Republic of Togo, 3 October 2026

  Togo's medium-term revenue mobilisation strategy for 2027–2031 allocates nearly FCFA 6 billion of its FCFA 10.5 billion budget to digitising the tax administration. Plans include e-invoicing, linking government information systems, risk-scoring of taxpayers, national hosting of tax data and possible use of artificial intelligence. The strategy targets FCFA 481 billion in additional revenue over the period.

DIGITAL, CYBERDEFENCE AND BIOMETRICS REFORM PROGRAMME

- **Togo Reports 68.4% Reform Implementation Rate at Mid-2026** — Togo First, 2 September 2026

  Togo's Ministry of Finance and Budget reported on 28 August 2026 that 68.4% of planned reforms had been implemented by end-June, with budget execution at 63.3%. Digital measures named include wider biometric identification and a broader mandate for Cyber Defense Africa. Allocations to local governments total CFAF 16 billion.

POLITIQUE NATIONALE DE PROTECTION SOCIALE

- **Togo: When Prime Minister Faure Gnassingbé makes social protection the cornerstone of inclusion and resilience** — Sahel Liberty News, 14 September 2026

  Togo's National Social Protection Programme, launched on 18 December 2025, pays unconditional cash transfers to more than 700,000 vulnerable people, with XOF 25,000 per household sent by mobile money. Initial funding of XOF 3.5 billion came with support from the World Bank, AFD and the African Development Bank. The September 2026 article reports no new development.

NATIONAL POLICY ON ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN TECHNICAL AND VOCATIONAL EDUCATION AND TRAINING

- **ETFP dual : le Togo mise sur l'entreprise, l'insertion et l'intelligence artificielle** — Ministère de l'Éducation Nationale (Togo), 22 September 2026

  Togo's education minister, Mama Omorou, opened a regional workshop in Lomé on 21 September 2026 on dual technical and vocational training in the digital era, attended by six countries. Its planned outputs are a private-sector engagement guide, operating scenarios for the InserJeune graduate-tracking tool and an expanded national policy on AI in vocational training.

Tunisia

NATIONAL E-COMMERCE STRATEGY

- **"الأونكتاد" يدعم تونس في إعداد إستراتيجية للتجارة الإلكترونية** — Al Chourouk, 21 September 2026

  UNCTAD is helping Tunisia's trade and export development ministry draft a national e-commerce strategy, with initial planning meetings held from 31 March to 2 April 2026, according to Ramzi Louati of Tunisia's mission in Geneva. No adoption date or drafting timetable is given.

NATIONAL HEALTH PACT

- **Santé : la Tunisie signe un Pacte national pour accélérer la couverture sanitaire universelle** — Tunisie Numerique, 2 October 2026

  Tunisia's health and communication technologies ministers signed a National Health Pact on 1 October to speed universal health coverage through digital transformation. Its six axes include sovereign governance of health data, modernised digital platforms and medicine supply-chain security; it is backed by the World Bank and WHO.

LA POSTE TUNISIENNE STRATEGY 2026-2030

- **Poste tunisienne : l'IA et le numérique au cœur de la stratégie 2026-2030 - Tunisie Numerique** — Tunisie Numerique, 9 October 2026

Tunisia's communications minister, Sofiene Hemissi, said on 9 October 2026 that La Poste tunisienne's 2026-2030 strategy will integrate artificial intelligence and digital identity into postal services. Its chief executive listed five priorities, including financial inclusion and e-commerce logistics, and an enterprise resource planning rollout under way. The minister ruled out turning the Post into a bank.

Uganda

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE STRATEGY

- **Uganda Targets AI Sovereignty, Minister Says** — Nile Post, 10 September 2026

  Uganda is developing an artificial intelligence strategy aimed at building national capacity to develop, govern and benefit from the technology rather than depend on foreign systems, its science and technology minister said. He named data, computing infrastructure, energy, models, applications and skills as the foundations that need investment.

DOMESTIC TAXES COMPLIANCE RISK MANAGEMENT STRATEGY

- **URA unveils data driven tax compliance strategy for FY2026/27** — Eagle Online, 14 September 2026

  The Uganda Revenue Authority began implementing its taxpayer compliance risk management strategy and compliance improvement plan for 2026/27. It will use taxpayer records, transaction data and sector trends to target evasion, inaccurate declarations, non-registration and late filing, and prioritises compliance with the EFRIS e-invoicing system and digital tax stamps.

NATIONAL COMMUNICATION POLICY, 2026

- **Government Launches National Communication Policy 2026** — Ministry of ICT and National Guidance (Uganda), 13 October 2026

  Uganda's Minister of ICT and National Guidance, Justine Kasule Lumumba, launched the National Communication Policy, 2026 in Kampala on 13 October 2026. It sets common communication standards for ministries, agencies and local governments, covering crisis communication, access to public information and citizen feedback, and requires each to adopt and budget for an aligned communication strategy.

Zambia

GROW ZAMBIA AGENDA 2026-2031

- **Zambia places ICT at centre of new economic blueprint** — CAJ News Africa, 10 September 2026

  The Smart Zambia Institute, the government's e-government agency, endorsed President Hakainde Hichilema's Grow Zambia Agenda 2026–2031, which carries eight national targets on digital infrastructure, CAJ News reported on 10 September 2026. National coordinator Percy Chinyama said the institute is building a real-time dashboard reporting progress on all targets to Cabinet, and is digitising 2.5 million smallholder farmers under the National Farmer Registry.

FRAMEWORK FOR CONTENT-CREATOR EARNINGS FROM DIGITAL PLATFORMS

- **Zambia unlocks digital earnings for creators** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026

  Zambia's technology and youth ministries are developing a framework for local content creators to earn from digital platforms, and are talking to Meta, TikTok and Google about the legal and technical arrangements. The President named it a priority when opening the 14th National Assembly, and a national database of creators is being compiled.

Zimbabwe

POSTAL AND COURIER SERVICES POLICY

- **Mavetera sets 2030 deadline for Smart Post Offices** — Spiked Media, 19 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT, Postal and Courier Services ministry set 2030 as the deadline to turn the country's more than 250 post offices into Smart Post Offices, announced at a postal conference in Harare on 18 September 2026. The plan includes a ring-fenced fund for Zimpost's universal service obligation, AI parcel tracking and drone delivery. A postal policy and an e-commerce bill are being drafted.

- **Zimbabwe sets out plan to modernise postal and courier services for digital economy** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister Tatenda Mavetera set out a three-phase plan for the postal and courier sector at its annual conference: ring-fencing the Universal Service Fund, then Smart Post Offices by 2030 with AI, drones and e-commerce, then strategic equity partnerships. A Postal and Telecommunications Amendment Bill is before Parliament and an E-Commerce and E-Transactions Bill is being drafted.

REGULATOR'S COMMERCIAL ARRANGEMENTS UNIT

- **ICT Minister Mavetera directs Potraz to establish unit to police operator deals** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 6 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister asked the telecommunications regulator to consider a dedicated unit to oversee operators' commercial arrangements, mediate disputes and enforce active infrastructure sharing. She also wants the Universal Service Fund to reach every marginalised ward and the regulator's sharing and tower-relocation directives evaluated in 2027.

POSTAL AND COURIER SECTOR TRANSFORMATION IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

- **Government gives postal sector 90 days for transformation plan** — The Herald, 12 October 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister gave her ministry, the regulator and the postal operator 90 days to produce a costed plan for the postal and courier sector to 2030, with quarterly reporting. She also directed operators to comply with the Cyber and Data Protection Act and required pilots of artificial intelligence and drones to carry a named lead, a timetable and measurable benefits.

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